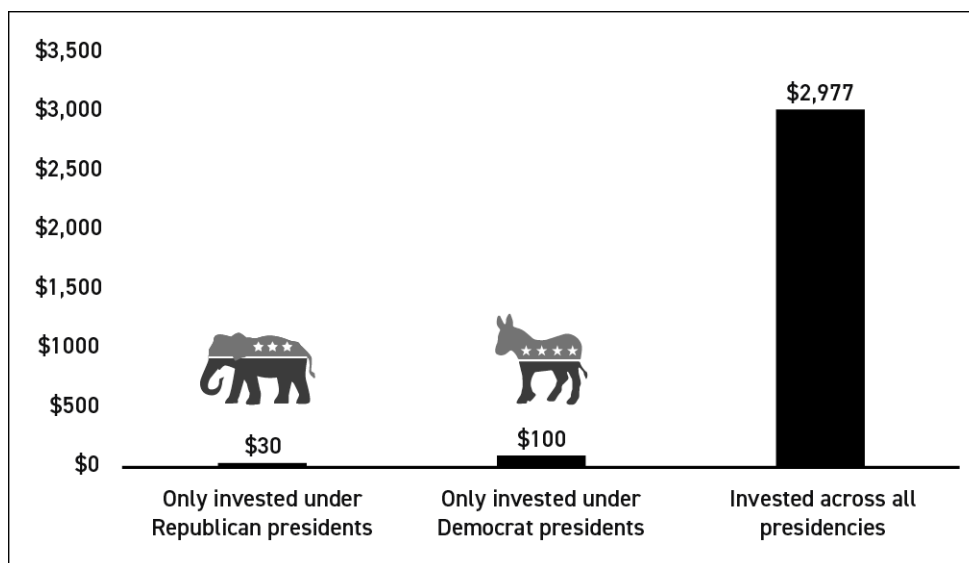




The conclusion should be obvious: When you are in the polling booth, vote your conscience, but when you are reviewing your investing options, it is best to do so with a cold, dispassionate eye.

Understanding how your own biases impact your investing process is a key step. If you want to avoid making certain errors, you must at least be aware of them.



Boskin's poorly timed, politically motivated op-ed cost his readers untold billions in market appreciation. But it's only the second worst-timed editorial in market history.³²¹

The very worst op-ed in history? That's up next.

³¹⁴ Barry Ritholtz, "Why politics and investing don't mix," *The Washington Post* (February 6, 2011).

³¹⁵ Alexander J. Shackman, Andrew S. Fox, and David A. Seminowicz, "The cognitive-emotional brain: Opportunities and challenges for understanding neuropsychiatric disorders," *Behavioral and Brain Sciences* 38(86) (June 8, 2015).

³¹⁶

Magdalena Ewa Krol and Wael El-Deredy, "When Believing is Seeing: The Role of Predictions in Shaping Visual Perception," *Journal of Experimental Psychology* 64(9) (September 1, 2011).

³¹⁷ Michael J. Boskin, "Obama's Radicalism Is Killing the Dow," *The Wall Street Journal* (March 6, 2009).